

SPEECH: WORDS OF THREE SYLLABLES STRESSED ON THE 2ND SYLLABLE

Stress is the degree of force by which a word is pronounced. Words are broken into tiny units called syllables. A syllable is the pronounced unit of a word. It is on a syllable that stress is placed. Stressing a syllable therefore means giving it more force, such that it is louder, longer and higher in pitch than other syllables.

A stressed syllable like in the dictionary is indicated by placing a stroke at the beginning of the syllable, but here, a stressed syllable should be written in capital letters.

THREE SYLLABLE WORDS

Three syllable words are parts of polysyllable words which have their different stress patterns with some guiding rules. These rules help us to identify when to stress the word on the first, second, third or fourth syllable.

For three syllable words stressed on the second syllable, the rule guiding it says

- a. Stress the second syllable from the end of a word if it ends in : - cient, - ion, - ic, - ial, - ian.

Examples

suf-FI-cient

ef- FI-cient

ic

stra-TE-gic

dra-MA-tic

-ion

o-CCA-sion

pro-JEC-tion

dis-CU-ssion

con-VIC-tion

in-JEC-tion

star-VA-tion

con-VER-sion

con-STRUC-tion

fru-STRA-tion

o-VA-tion

-ial

co-LO-nial

of-FI-cial

com-MER-cial

-ian

ci-VI-lian

Examples of the three syllable words in a sentence

1. The fru-STRA-tion in that job is too much
2. She is at the venue for col-LA-tion of results
3. The people in overalls are con-STRUC-tion workers
4. Something dra-MA-tic happened yesterday
5. I am a ci-VI-lian not a soldier

Assignment

Mention ten (10) words of three syllables stressed on the 2nd syllable